

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

What's your sign?



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about your astrological sign?
- Do you think that you fit the general description of your star sign? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss coincidences and strange events.
- I can say what happened and what was happening, what had happened, and what had been happening.
- I can speculate about the past with different degrees of certainty.





Let's Explore!

Peter talks about his **star sign***.

* Your "star sign" is also your astrological sign, based on when in the solar calendar you were born.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** So Peter, I know you believe in Mercury retrograde and after the past couple weeks that I've had, I'm beginning to give credence to it too. I think all of the unusual things that have been happening lately must have been caused by the retrograde.
- Peter:** Yes, I definitely think the retrograde could have been responsible for any malfunction with the electronics.
- Vanessa:** So do you also believe that your star sign dictates your personality and your relationships?
- Peter:** Yes, I do. I'm an Aquarius. We have been described as witty, clever, inventive and original.
- Vanessa:** Well, you are witty and you can be inventive. I remember when you were working at the first PR firm. You wrote a lot of really creative copy.
- Peter:** We can also be stubborn and rebellious. I remember when I had been working at that company for about 6 months and my supervisor started really critiquing my work. I had written a piece that I was really happy with and he edited it heavily. He tried to explain why he had made the edits that he did and I got really sarcastic with him. That's another trait of Aquarians.
- Vanessa:** I remember you telling me about that. If you hadn't spoken to him like that, you could have stayed there longer.
- Peter:** Yeah, that was the beginning of the end. It might have been better if I'd stayed there a bit longer, but I'm happy that I left. He was a Virgo ... not a good match for Aquarius!
- Vanessa:** Oh, then you must have been relieved when you could leave! What about now? Is your current manager a good match for you?
- Peter:** Yes, actually he is. He's a Gemini. Not many other signs get along well with Gemini but I tend to. You have to be pretty laid-back to deal with the Gemini personality.
- Vanessa:** Well, you are definitely laid-back!





Let's Practice!

Vanessa believes in these strange events!

Instructions: Circle the correct words to complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) I know you believe in Mercury retrograde and after the past couple weeks that I've had, I'm beginning **to give credence to / to critique / to invent** it too.
- 2) I consider myself as a **very origin / inventive / witty**, clever, inventive and original person.
- 3) Well, you are witty and you can be **inventive / sarcastic / critic**. I remember when you wrote that really creative essay.
- 4) My supervisor started **critiquing / to give credence / to invent** my work.
- 5) I got really **sarcastic / original / creative** with him when he started to explain why he had made the edits. That was rude but he deserved it.



Let's Practice!

Vanessa and Peter are speculating about the past.

Instructions: Read the clues on the left. Select the correct box in the table. Practice saying the sentences aloud to a partner.

	Speculate that something happened	Speculate that something did not happen	Speculate that something was impossible
All the unusual things happening lately must have been caused by the retrograde.			
The retrograde could have been responsible for any malfunction with electronics.			
If you hadn't spoken to him like that, you could have stayed there longer.			
It might have been better if I'd stayed there a bit longer.			
You must have been relieved when you could leave!			
This couldn't have happened with a Gemini!			





Extension Activity

Research your star sign.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On the Internet, research your star sign.
- Make notes about the personality characteristics of your sign and also make notes of which signs you are most compatible with.
- Make a poster for your star sign. Include characteristics and compatibility.
- Present your poster to your class or group.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research my star sign on the Internet.

☐
☐

I make notes about my star sign.

☐
☐

I make a poster for my star sign.

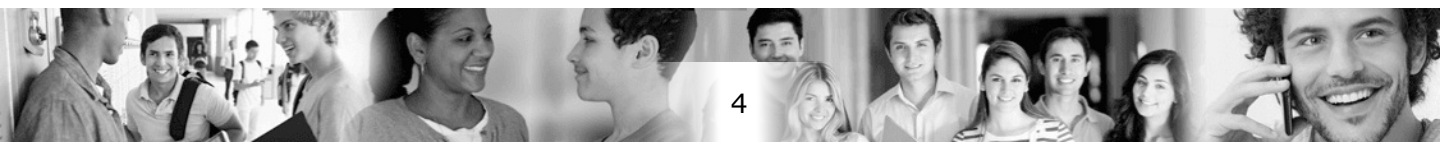
☐
☐

I present my poster to a group.

☐
☐


Target Words

- to give credence** (expression): to consider something to be trustworthy or believable
e.g. I'm beginning to give credence to it too.
- witty** (adjective): using words in an intelligent and amusing way
e.g. We have been described as witty, clever, inventive and original.
- inventive** (adjective): having the ability to design or create something new
e.g. You are witty and you can be inventive.
- sarcastic** (adjective): using irony to mock or show contempt
e.g. He tried to explain why he had made the edits that he did and I got really sarcastic with him.
- rebellious** (adjective): showing a desire to resist authority, control, or convention
e.g. We can also be stubborn and rebellious.
- to critique** (verb): to review or analyze a work
e.g. My supervisor started really critiquing my work.
- current** (adjective): belonging to the present time
e.g. Is your current manager a good match for you?





Learning Points

Narrative Tenses: Simple Past, Past Continuous, Past Perfect and Past Perfect Continuous

You refer to the past time by using narrative tenses. You use them to describe past events or tell stories.

You use the **Simple Past** to talk about a definite time in the past. When an action is finished, you use the Simple Past.

We **saw** a wonderful film last night.

You use the **Past Continuous** to talk about an action that is in progress in the past.

We **were having** a serious discussion when someone screamed.

You use the **Past Perfect** to talk about an action or state that happened at a time before another past action or state.

When we bought our tickets at the theater, the movie **had already started**.

You use the **Past Perfect Continuous** to talk about an action was happening before a certain time in the past, or before another past action happened. You often use it in conjunction with the Simple Past.

When he finally arrived, she **had been standing** in the rain for over half an hour!

Examples:

- I remember when you were working at the first PR firm.
- You wrote a lot of really creative copy.
- I remember when I had been working at that company for about 6 months and my supervisor started really critiquing my work.
- I had written a piece that I was really happy with and he edited it heavily.
- He tried to explain why he had made that edits that he did and I got really sarcastic with him.





Learning Points

Speculating About the Past with Different Degrees of Certainty

You use different modal verbs to show the degree of certainty when you want to hypothesize (when you say what you think is true or not true about an event in the past).

When evidence is taken into consideration and then a reasonably certain conclusion is made about what happened in the past, then you use **must have** and **couldn't have** plus the past participle of the verb to speculate.

Look at the chart for some examples of how to speculate:

Modal Verb Phrase	Use/Meaning	Example
<i>must have + past participle</i>	When you speculate that something did happen	<i>Nancy has a tan - she must have spent a lot of time in the sun lately.</i>
<i>must not have + past participle</i>	When you speculate that something <u>did not</u> happen	<i>He must not have cleaned his room because there is still laundry everywhere!</i>
<i>could not have + past participle.</i>	When you speculate that something <u>was impossible</u>	<i>Jessica couldn't have stolen Sarah's bag - she wasn't even here today!</i>

Examples:

- *I think all of the unusual things that have been happening lately must have been caused by the retrograde.*
- *I definitely think the retrograde could have been responsible for any malfunction with electronics.*
- *If you hadn't spoken to him like that, you could have stayed there longer.*
- *It might have been better if I'd stayed there a bit longer, but I'm happy that I left.*
- *You must have been relieved when you could leave!*

